

5. **Human capital formation as a concept is better explained in terms of a process, which enables**
1. individuals of a country to accumulate more capital
 2. increasing the knowledge
 3. increasing the skill levels
 4. increasing the knowledge, skill levels and capacities of the people of the country

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1 (b) 1 and 2
(c) 3 and 4 (d) Only 4

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Ans. (d)

Human capital formation as a concept is better explained in increasing the knowledge, skill levels and capacities of the people of the country. Hence option (d) is correct.

Agriculture and Allied Sector

1. **In India, the agricultural 'crop year' period is**

- (a) 1st January - 31st December
(b) 1st April - 31st March
(c) 1st June - 31st May
(d) 1st July - 30th June
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (d)

The agricultural crop year in India is from 1st July - 30th June. There are three distinct crop season in India, namely Kharif, Rabi and Zaid.

2. **What was the principal source of the Indian economy on the eve of independence?**

- (a) Agricultural sector (b) Industrial sector
(c) IT sector (d) Foreign trade sector

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Ans. (a)

The principle source of Indian economy on the eve of independence was Agricultural sector. Agriculture was the first considered source of income and occupation in the Indian economy.

3. **The target for total agricultural credit fixed in Budget of the GOI, 2020-21 is**

- (a) ₹12 lakh crore (b) ₹13 lakh crore
(c) ₹14 lakh crore (d) ₹15 lakh crore
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

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Ans. (d)

The agriculture credit flow for the year 2020-21 was 15,75,398 crore against the target of 15,00,000 crore for the year. Agricultural credit is special credit advanced to farmers, agricultural producers, and others to finance agricultural transactions. A provision of ₹ 1.52 lakh crore for agriculture and allied sector announced under latest budget (2024-25) and agricultural credit is of 24 lakh crore.

4. **What is the policy measure adopted by the Government of India to improve the system of agricultural marketing?**

- (a) Public Distribution System (PDS)
(b) Minimum Support Price (MSP)
(c) Maintenance of Buffer Stock
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

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Ans. (d)

Public Distribution System (PDS), Minimum Support Price (MSP) and Maintenance of Buffer Stock etc. are policy measure adopted by Government of India to improve the system of agricultural marketing.

5. **Which one among the followings is not an objective of food management in India?**

- (a) Distribution of food grains
(b) Procurement of food grains
(c) Maintenance of food grains buffer stock
(d) Export of food grains
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

Procurement and distribution of food grains and maintenance of food grains buffer stock are main objectives of food management in India, while export of food grains is not an objective of food management in India.

6. **Which agency is responsible for procurement, distribution and food grain production in India?**

- (a) Ministry of Agriculture
(b) Food Corporation of India
(c) TRIFED
(d) NAFED
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

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Ans. (b)

The Food Corporation of India (FCI) is the agency responsible for procurement, distribution, and food grain production India. It is a government - owned corporation that operates under the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution.

FCI plays a crucial role in ensuring food security in the country by procuring food grains from farmers, maintaining buffer stocks, and distributing them through the Public Distribution System (PDS) and other welfare schemes.

7. The size of marginal landholding in India is :

- (a) More than 5 hectares (b) 2 hectares to 4 hectares
- (c) 1 hectare to 2 hectares (d) less than 1 hectare
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

In Indian Agriculture Census, the operational holdings are categorized into five size classes :

- 1. Marginal – Below 1 hectare
- 2. Small – 1 to 2 hectares
- 3. Semi-Medium – 2 to 4 hectares
- 4. Medium – 4 to 10 hectares
- 5. Large – 10 hectare and above

8. The average size of landholdings in Bihar in comparison with other States is :

- (a) lowest (b) second lowest
- (c) highest (d) second highest
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

As per the latest Agriculture Census 2015-16, the average size of landholdings in Bihar is 0.39 hectare which is second lowest (after Kerala – 0.18 hectare) in comparison with other States of India.

9. The share of agriculture and allied sectors in the Gross Domestic Product of India is :

- (a) 22 percent (b) 80 percent
- (c) 33 percent (d) 15 percent

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

In the year 2008-09 (when the question was asked), the share of agriculture and allied sectors in the Gross Domestic Product of India was about 15%. As per the Economic Survey 2023-24, the share of agriculture and allied sector in Nominal GVA (at current prices) is at 17.7% in 2023-24.

10. The average yield of cotton is highest in India for the State of :

- (a) West Bengal (b) Bihar
- (c) Assam (d) Andhra Pradesh
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (e)

As per third meeting of committee on Cotton Production and Consumption (COCPC) for the cotton season 2023-24, the average yield of cotton is highest in India for the State of Gujarat (574.06 kg per hectare). Gujarat is followed by Odisha 554.86 kg/hectare. The yield of cotton in Andhra Pradesh is 292.06 kg/hectare in 2023-24.

11. The raw materials on which the cotton industries are dependent are-

- (a) weight loss oriented (b) load- increment oriented
- (c) weight-equal root (d) none of the above

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

The inputs used in the cotton industry – cotton, jute, wool etc. are of weight-decreasing nature. The weight of these raw materials is high in the initial stage and their weight decreases after a certain period of time. It is only after this period that they come back to their original form.

12. During which year was the average annual growth rate (at constant prices) of agriculture and allied sectors negative?

- (a) 2002-03 (b) 2003-04
- (c) 2005-06 (d) 2006-07

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

As per the 1st and 2nd revised estimates of 2014-15, the agriculture and allied sectors had reported negative growth rate at (–) 0.2 and (–) 0.3 percent respectively. At present Economic Survey 2023-24, Indian agriculture sector provides livelihood support to about 42.3 percent of the population and has a share of 18.2% in the country's current GDP at current price. Average annual growth rate is 4.18% at constant price over last 5 years but as per provisional estimate growth rate is 1.4% (2023-24).

13. Which State ensures the maximum production of Coffee in India?

- (a) Maharashtra (b) Karnataka
- (c) Tamil Nadu (d) Kerala

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The State of Karnataka is the largest producer of coffee in India. Karnataka contributed about 70% of the total coffee production in India during 2022-23 (Final Estimates) with 2,48,020 MT coffee production. Karnataka is followed by Kerala (72,425 MT) and Tamil Nadu (18,700 MT) in coffee production in 2022-23. The Coffee Board of India predicts that the 2023-24 crop year will see a 6.25% increase in productions with a total crop of 374,000 MT.

14. Which one of the following is the leading producer of Coffee in India?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Tamil Nadu
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

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Ans. (b)

Karnataka is the leading producer of coffee in India. As per 2nd (AE) 2023-24 total coffee production in India is 0.4 million tonnes (Dept of Agriculture and Farmer Welfare).

15. Consider the following statements regarding agriculture and trade of India during the year 2001-02 and 2002-03-

1. Agricultural imports contributed about 12% of India's total imports.
2. The contribution of edible oils to India's total agro-import value was about 62%.
3. Agriculture exports contributed about 4% to India's total exports.
4. Marine products contributed about 23% to the total agricultural export value in India.

Which of these statements are correct?

- (a) 2 and 4
- (b) 1 and 2
- (c) 2 and 3
- (d) 1, 3 and 4

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

In the years 2001-02 and 2002-03, the share of agricultural imports in India's total imports was 3.75% and 4.6% respectively. In these years, the import of edible oil was about 62% of the total agricultural import. In 2002-03, the share of agricultural exports in total exports was 11.8% and not 4%. According to the Ministry of Commerce and Industry India shipped seafood of worth ₹ 60,523.89 crore during financial year 2023-24. Seafood export accounted for 17% of India's agricultural export Ministry of Commerce and Industry.

16. The country, which is the largest silk producer in the world, is :

- (a) India
- (b) China
- (c) Brazil
- (d) Japan
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Statement 1 is true as India is the only country in the world producing all the five known commercial varieties of silk. These are – Mulberry silk, Tropical Tasar silk, Oak Tasar silk, Eri silk and Muga silk. India is the second-largest producer of silk (after China) in the world.

As per the data of FAO, in 2023-24, India is the largest producer of sugar in the world while Brazil is the second-largest producer. Hence, Statement-2 is incorrect.

17. Consider the following states-

- (1) Punjab
- (2) Uttar Pradesh
- (3) Andhra Pradesh
- (4) West Bengal

Choose the correct ascending order of the above as rice producing states in India.

- (a) West Bengal, Punjab, Andhra Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh
- (b) West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, Andhra Pradesh, Punjab
- (c) Andhra Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, West Bengal, Punjab
- (d) Andhra Pradesh, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, West Bengal
- (e) None of the above/ more than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

According to the Economic Survey, 2022-23, the ascending order of alternative rice producing states in the year 2021-22 (4th A.E.) is as follows–

West Bengal < Uttar Pradesh < Punjab < Andhra Pradesh.

As per 2024 Reports Top 4 rice producing states in India are–

- West Bengal
- Uttar Pradesh
- Punjab
- Tamilnadu

18. Brown Manuring, a recent approach of weed control, is mostly used in

- (a) Maize
- (b) Sugarcane
- (c) Wheat
- (d) Direct seeded rice
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (d)

Brown manuring, a recent approach of weed control, is mostly used in direct seeded rice cultivation. Brown manuring is an eco-friendly weed management technique that involves incorporating green manure crops into the soil before planting the main crop. In the case of direct seeded rice cultivation, brown manuring involves incorporating green manure crops, such as sunnhemp or dhaincha, into the soil during the fallow period before rice planting.

19. Which one of the following is the pathway to increase productivity in agriculture?

- (a) Efficient irrigation (b) Quality seeds
- (c) Use of pesticides (d) Use of fertilizers
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (e)

Efficient irrigation, quality seeds, use of pesticides and use of fertilizers – all of these are important to increase productivity in agriculture. Hence, the correct answer is option (e).

20. What percentage of labour force is provided direct employment by the agriculture sector in India?

- (a) 20% (b) 30%
- (c) 40% (d) 65%

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre), 2001

Ans. (*)

As per 2001 Census, 58.2% of Indian labour force was connected to agriculture sector. According to the 2011 Census, about 54.6% of the total work force of the country is associated with the agriculture sector.

21. Which of the following is not a cash crop?

- (a) Jute (b) Groundnut
- (c) Jowar (d) Sugarcane
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

A cash crop is simply an agricultural crop that grown to sell for profit only and not for self-consumption. Jute, Groundnut and Sugarcane are cash crops while Jowar is not a cash crop and it is a coarse food grain.

22. Which one of the following is not included in the National Food Security Mission?

- (a) Wheat (b) Oilseeds
- (c) Rice (d) Pulses

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (*)

National Food Security Mission (NFSM) was launched in October, 2007 (from Rabi 2007-08 season) as a centrally sponsored scheme to increase the annual production of rice by 10 million tons, wheat by 8 million tons and pulses by 2 million tons (Total 20 million tons of additional food grains) by the end of the 11th Plan (2011-12). At that time NFSM did not comprise coarse cereals and hence option (d) was the right answer for the question period. Coarse cereals were included from 2014-15 under NFSM.

NFSM continued during 12th Five Year Plan with new targets of additional production of 25 million tons of foodgrains comprising 10 million tons of rice, 8 million tons of wheat, 4 million tons of pulses and 3 million tons of coarse cereals by the end of 12th Plan. Commercial crops (viz. cotton, jute and sugarcane) were also included under NFSM's ambit.

Based on past experience and performance of 12th Plan, it has been decided to continue the NFSM beyond 12th Plan i.e. 2017-18 to 2019-20 with new targets to achieve 13 million tons of additional foodgrains production comprising 5 million tons of rice, 3 million tons of wheat, 3 million tons of pulses and 2 million tons of nutri-cum-coarse cereals by 2019-20. From the year 2018-19 and 2019-20, National Mission on Oilseeds and Oil Palm (NMOOP) and Seed Village Programme are now a part of NFSM and thus NFSM now have 8 components viz. **(i) NFSM-Rice; (ii) NFSM-Wheat; (iii) NFSM-Pulses; (iv) NFSM-Coarse Cereals (Maize, Barley); (v) NFSM-Sub Mission on Nutri-Cereals; (vi) NFSM-Commercial crops; (vii) NFSM-Oilseeds and Oil Palm; and (viii) NFSM-Seed Village Programme.**

23. The most important fish industry in India is :

- (a) at deep water
- (b) at above sea-coast
- (c) at cultural inland
- (d) at natural inland

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

At present, the most important fish industry in India is at natural inland. India's inland fisheries resources are as diverse as they are plentiful, comprising rivers, floodplains, estuaries, mangroves, impoundments, lagoons, lakes, reservoirs and ponds. As per the 'Handbook on Fisheries Statistics : 2022' released by the Department of Fisheries, Government of India the marine and inland fish production in India in recent years is as follows :

Fish Production (in Lakh Tonnes)			
Year	Marine	Inland	Total
2015-16	36.00	71.62	107.62
2016-17	36.25	78.06	114.31
2017-18	37.56	89.48	127.04
2018-19	38.53	97.20	135.73
2019-20	37.27	104.37	141.64
2020-21	34.76	112.49	147.25
2021-22	41.27	121.21	162.48

Note: The fish production in the country rose from 7.52 lakh tonne in 1950-51 to an all time record of 175.45 tons in 2022-23. Which is more than 23 fold increase in national fish production. (Source : Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying)

24. The largest wheat producing state in India is-

- (a) Punjab (b) Haryana
(c) Uttar Pradesh (d) Bihar

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997-98

Ans. (c)

According to Question Hour and Economic Survey, 2021-22 also option (c) is the correct answer. According to the Economic Survey 2023-24, the top three wheat producing states are Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Punjab respectively.

25. What was the total production of wheat in India as per the 4th advance estimates in the year 2020-21?

- (a) 109.5 million tonnes (b) 209.5 million tonnes
(c) 501.5 million tonnes (d) 20123 million tonnes
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)2021

Ans. (a)

According to the Economic Survey, 2021-22, the total production of wheat in India in the fourth advance estimate for the year 2020-21 was 109.5 million tonnes. As per economic survey 2023-24, the total production of wheat in India was 112.9 million tonnes.

26. Which of the following is not top Soyabean growing State?

- (a) Chhattisgarh (b) Maharashtra
(c) Rajasthan (d) Madhya Pradesh
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

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Ans. (a)

The major soyabean growing states are Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Rajasthan, Karnataka and Telangana. Among the states, Madhya pradesh stood first with 52.05 lakh ha followed by Maharashtra (45.64 lakh ha). Rajasthan (10.94 lakh ha) Hence, Chhattisgarh is not the top soyabean producing state.

27. Which industry of India was worst affected due to partition?

- (a) cotton and sugar industry
(b) engineering and cement industry
(c) jute and cotton industry
(d) paper and iron industry

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

The modern jute industry in India is about 165 years old. In 1855, the first jute mill was established at a place called Rishra near Serampore. The partition of India in 1947 damaged the jute industry because Most of the jute production area (about 80%) remained in East Pakistan (present-day Bangladesh). As a result, the problem of raw material arose in front of the jute industry. On the other hand, most of the cotton textile mills were in Mumbai, and Ahmedabad (India), while 40 percent of the cotton producing area had gone to West Pakistan.

28. Black revolution is related to the :

- (a) Fish production
(b) Coal production
(c) Crude oil production
(d) Mustard production
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Crude petroleum is originally found in black colour. It is also known as '**Black Gold**'. In order to increase the production of crude oil, the term 'Black revolution' was coined.
Blue revolution — Fish production
White revolution — Dairy farming / Milk production
Red revolution — Meat/Tomato production
Green revolution — Foodgrain production
Yellow revolution — Oilseeds production

29. Match List-I with List-II :

List-I List-II

- A. Grey Revolution 1. Onion production**
B. Pink Revolution 2. Tomato and meat production

C. Silver Revolution**D. Red Revolution**

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|----------------------------|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 4 | 2 | 3 |
| (b) | 4 | 1 | 3 | 2 |
| (c) | 3 | 1 | 4 | 2 |
| (d) | More than one of the above | | | |
| (e) | None of the above | | | |

3. Production of eggs**4. Fertilizers****68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022****Ans. (b)**

List-I	List-II
Grey Revolution	Fertilizers
Pink Revolution	Onion production
Silver Revolution	Production of eggs
Red Revolution	Tomato and meat production

30. Which one of the following most appropriately describes the nature of Green Revolution of late sixties of 20th century?

- Intensive cultivation of green vegetables
- Intensive agriculture district programme
- High-yielding varieties programme
- Seed-Fertilizer-Water technology
- None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018**Ans. (d)**

Among the given options, Seed-Fertilizer-Water technology most appropriately describes the nature of Green Revolution in India which was initiated in late sixties of 20th century. By using seeds with improved genetics (high-yielding variety seeds), fertilizers, water for irrigation, agricultural machinery, pesticides etc., the Green Revolution changed India's status from a food-deficient country to one of the world's leading agricultural nations.

31. The success of the Green Revolution depends on the availability of-

- high yielding variety of seeds
- adequate irrigation facility
- chemical fertilizers and pesticides
- none of these

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997-98**Ans. (a)**

The Green Revolution was launched in 1966 as a package program consisting of the following inputs:

- High yielding varieties of seeds
- Fertilizers
- insecticides and
- Adequate irrigation facilities

Although the above mentioned four elements are necessary for the Green Revolution, high productivity seeds imported from Mexico played an important role in bringing about the Green Revolution.

32. Consider the following Statements :

- Varsha Bima, the rainfall insurance scheme, is managed by the Agriculture Insurance Company of India Ltd. (AICIL).**
- The scheme was introduced during the 2007 South-West monsoon period.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- Only 1
- Only 2
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015**Ans. (a)**

The Agriculture Insurance Company of India Ltd. (AICIL) introduced a rainfall insurance scheme known as '**Varsha Bima**' in India during the 2004 South-West Monsoon Period. Varsha Bima was piloted in 20 areas of Andhra Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka and Rajasthan. Hence, only Statement 1 is correct.

Weather Based Crop Insurance Scheme (WBCIS) was launched from Kharif 2007, which was implemented by the AICIL. At present, the AICIL and other public sector and private sector general insurance companies impanelled by the Ministry of Agriculture and selected by the concerned State/UT Government implement the restructured WBCIS.

33. The objective of PM-KUSUM Scheme is:

- To reduce farmers' dependence on monsoon for irrigation
- To reduce farmers' dependence on money-lenders for credit
- Promotion of floriculture in India
- To remove farmers' dependence on diesel and kerosene and to link pump sets to solar energy
- None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020**Ans. (d)**

PM-KUSUM (Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha evam Utthaan Mahabhiyaan) Scheme is aimed at ensuring energy security for farmers in India, along with honouring India's commitment to increase the share of installed capacity of electric power from non-fossil fuel sources to 40% by 2030 as part of Intended Nationally Determined Contributions (INDCs). The PM-KUSUM Scheme was launched in 2019. Removing farmers' dependence on diesel and kerosene and linking agricultural pump sets to solar energy are among the main objectives of this scheme.

34. How much amount is the part of the Financial Outlay 2023-24, of the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi?

- (a) 36,250 crore (b) 55,000 crore
(c) 60,000 crore (d) 23,000 crore

B.P.S.C. Assistant Mains (GK) Paper II 2023

Ans. (c)

The government allocated a budget of ₹ 60000 crore for the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi for financial year 2024-25. The PM-KISAN, a central sector scheme, aims at providing financial assistance to all cultivable landholding farmers families across the country, subject to certain exclusion criteria.

35. Who determines the minimum support price in India?

- (a) The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices
(b) The Agriculture Ministry
(c) The Finance Commission
(d) NABARD
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP) since 1985, earlier named as Agricultural Prices Commission) came into existence in January, 1965. It is mandated to recommend minimum support prices (MSPs) to incentivize the cultivators to adopt modern technology, and raise productivity and overall grain production in line with the emerging demands patterns in the country. MSP for major agricultural products are fixed by the government, each year, after taking into account the recommendations of the CACP. Note : Currently 22 commodities are covered under Minimum Support Price (MSP).

36. Which is not a source of agricultural finance in India?

- (a) Co-operative Societies (b) Commercial Banks
(c) Regional Rural Banks (d) None of these

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (d)

The source of agricultural finance in India is divided into two categories :

A. Institutional sources, in which the prominent are :

- (1) Cooperative Societies and Banks
(2) Commercial Banks
(3) Regional Rural Banks
(4) Government

B. Non-institutional sources : Private money-lenders, relatives, businessman, land-lord etc.

As per NAFIS Report 2016-17, in 2015 the share of institutional credit in agriculture was approximately 72 percent, while the share of non-institutional credit in agriculture was 28 percent.

37. Most of the people in India are useless-

- (a) in industry (b) in agriculture
(c) in mining (d) none of these

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997-98

Ans. (b)

The distinguishing feature of Indian agriculture is that labour is employed more than the requirement in this sector. In fact, disguised unemployment is a feature of the Indian agricultural sector.

38. Which one is not included in the Field of Land Reforms in India?

- (a) Abolition of middlemen
(b) Consolidation of land holdings
(c) Cooperative agriculture
(d) Housing loans to farmers

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997-98

Ans. (d)

After independence the following steps were taken to fulfill the objective of land reform-

1. Abolition of intermediaries or middlemen.
2. Under the Tenancy Reform, steps were taken like regulation of rent, protection of tenancy rights, providing ownership rights on land to the tenants.
3. Reorganization of agriculture- Under this redistribution of land, aggregation of land holdings or consolidation of holdings and cooperative farming are included.